

Self-Assessment — Sample Questions

Reflection prompts & model pointers · independent study

Use these questions to test your understanding as you progress. Each is drawn from the reflection focus of a unit; a model pointer indicates the kind of answer expected. These are formative and not assessed.

1 UNIT 1

Q. What distinguishes a genuinely creative idea from one that is merely novel or merely useful?

Model pointer. Apply Runco & Jaeger's standard definition: creativity requires BOTH originality and effectiveness. Use Amabile's componential model to explain how expertise, creative-thinking skill and intrinsic motivation combine.

2 UNIT 2

Q. Why can a psychologically unsafe team fail to produce ideas even when it contains talented individuals?

Model pointer. Draw on Edmondson: without psychological safety, members withhold ideas and dissent. Contrast with Osborn's deferred-judgement rule and de Bono's parallel thinking as structures that make sharing safer.

3 UNIT 3

Q. How does the Double Diamond guard against solving the wrong problem?

Model pointer. Explain the problem diamond (Discover→Define) preceding the solution diamond (Develop→Deliver), and the diverge/converge rhythm. Link to desirability–feasibility–viability as the balance test.

4 UNIT 4

Q. Give an example where the '5 Whys' would reveal a different root cause than the presenting symptom.

Model pointer. Show an iterative why-chain moving from symptom to a process/system cause. Note Ohno's origin in the Toyota Production System and the risk of stopping at a convenient cause.

5 UNIT 5

Q. What can an empathy map capture that a persona alone cannot?

Model pointer. Empathy maps surface says/thinks/does/feels tensions (e.g. stated vs. felt); personas fix a segment archetype. Both feed the Define stage; reference AEIOU for structured observation.

6 UNIT 6

Q. Rewrite a vague problem as a Point-of-View statement and derive two 'How Might We' questions.

Model pointer. PoV = user + need + insight. HMW should be neither too broad nor too narrow. Reference Wedell-Wedellsborg on reframing to check you are solving the right problem.

7 UNIT 7

Q. When is Blue Ocean / ERRC a better ideation move than incremental brainstorming?

Model pointer. When the category itself is saturated (red ocean). ERRC reshapes the value curve (eliminate/reduce/raise/create). Contrast with SCAMPER and brainwriting for incremental generation.

8 UNIT 8

Q. Why is an MVP not simply a smaller product?

Model pointer. It is a learning device to test the riskiest assumption via build–measure–learn (Ries). Contrast paper/low-fi and Wizard of Oz prototypes as fidelity matched to the question.

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continued

9 UNIT 9

Q. How does an A/B test provide evidence that a usability interview cannot?

Model pointer. Randomised controlled comparison attributes causation to the change (Kohavi). Usability testing reveals task friction; solution interviews test problem–solution fit; feedback grids structure reactions.

10 UNIT 10

Q. What makes design thinking survive beyond a single workshop in an organisation?

Model pointer. Implementation as organisational change: sponsorship, pilots, visible wins, capability building (Liedtka; Porcini at PepsiCo). Reference the implementation roadmap and define-success criteria.